

Best Practice Insights – Sponsors

24

1. What % of respondents with extremely effective sponsorship met or exceeded objectives?

79%

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2. What are the most critical activities sponsors need to perform (ABCs)?

- Active and Visible Participation throughout the project
- Build a coalition of sponsorship
- Communicate support and promote the change to impacted groups.

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3. What are the ideal sponsor traits?

- Strong communication skills
- Create engagement thru passion and enthusiasm
- Engaged and Involved
- Visible and supportive
- Approachable and Available
- Recognized leader with sponsorship experience.

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4. What are the Top 3 consequences of losing a sponsor and tactics for dealing with that loss?

- Project must start over
- Project loses momentum & stalls
- Project is delayed due to need to train & onboard new sponsor

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- Get new sponsor
- Make time to train new sponsor
- Create robust documentation

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Best Practice Insights – Managers

24

1. What are some tactics for ensuring managers spend adequate time managing change?

Support structured communications • Integrate change management into existing activities • Schedule meetings • Provide training • Involve other roles to champion change • Administer tools • Provide coaching

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2. What are the most critical roles of a manager?

Communicator, Liaison, Advocate, Resistance Manager, Coach

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3. What are the most common mistakes for people managers?

Role abdication • Communication mistakes • Failing to support staff • Ill-prepared • Resisting the change

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4. What percentage of respondents prepare managers and supervisors adequately?

35% (32% agree plus 3% strongly agree)

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Best Practice Insights – Communication

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1. Who are the two preferred senders and their key messages?

- Senior Leader/Primary Sponsor Organizational message
- People Manager/Supervisor Personal message

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2. What are the most important messages for employees to hear?

Business reasons for the change • Why the employees should want to participate • Impact of the change on employees • How the change was happening • Details about the change

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3. What is the “top do differently next time” finding regarding communication?

More Communication!

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4. How do you correct misinformation?

Enabling open discussion time • Identifying current rumors and addressing them immediately • Engaging sponsors • Providing regular communications • Updating Frequently Asked Questions • Providing information electronically

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Best Practice Insights – Resistance

25

1. Who are the most resistant groups?

Mid-level managers: 39% • Frontline employees: 27% • Senior-level managers: 16% • Executives and directors: 11%

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2. What are the top reasons employees resist change?

Lack of awareness • Change in role • Fear • Lack of support from in management or leadership • Lack of inclusion in the change

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3. What are the top reasons people managers resist change?

Organizational culture • Lack of awareness and knowledge about change • Lack of buy-in • Misalignment of project goals and personal incentives • Lack of confidence in their ability to manage people side of change

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4. What are ineffective methods for managing resistance?

Ignoring resistance • Broadcasting one-way communications • Using threats, fear or coercion • Dictating, mandating or telling people to change

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